TWIN FACES OF THE FUTURE

ISHA AMBANI, 30
AKASH AMBANI, 30

Directors, Reliance Jio Infocomm & Reliance Retail Ventures, Mumbai

THE NEXT 100
INHERITORS



ROHIT CHAWLA

"If you have to innovate on a wide scale, it has to come from the grassroots level. That is the DNA of Reliance. Now, it has come to Jio"
AKASH AMBANI

It was in 2014 that the Gen Next at Reliance Industries Limited (RIL), India's largest private sector company, took on management roles in group businesses. Both Isha Ambani and Akash Ambani joined Reliance Jio Infocomm and Reliance Retail Ventures as directors at the age of 24, the same age as their father Mukesh Ambani, who joined RIL in 1981. Isha, who graduated from Yale University with majors in psychology and South Asian studies in 2013, had a brief stint with McKinsey in the US. Akash graduated from Brown University with a major in economics and had been working on RIL's 4G telecom venture before becoming director.

Akash and Isha had been the key negotiators in mega deals struck by Jio Platforms with the likes of Google, Facebook and Intel to remould RIL into a futuristic enterprise. They have been involved in all key acquisitions by Jio Platforms, including Den Networks, Hathway Cable and Datacom. Akash is part of the Reliance Jio Infocomm executive committee, the firm's governing council, and also involved in the development of products and digital services applications. He is also into employee engagement initiatives to evolve a young and vibrant culture in the company. Akash is also handling sports businesses and running IPL team Mumbai Indians. Isha handles the consumer-oriented aspect of the business—consumer experience, branding and marketing. She assists mother Nita Ambani at Reliance Foundation and is working to build the next level of outreach in healthcare and education. ■

– M.G. Arun

LIVING THEIR PASSION Akash is an avid cricketer and football player. He represented the DAIS (Dhirubhai Ambani International School) football team for over five years. The passionate wildlife photographer often holidays with family at wildlife sanctuaries. Isha's hobbies include tennis and playing the piano.